

scanty supply of wood, and takes leave with many tears of his countless mistresses, whose grief is fully equal to his own. A storm that arises on the third day shatters his frail vessel, and he swims to a promontory, where he is received by a hospitable dame, who not only gives him abundant refreshment, but furnishes him with a new boat, in which he at last reaches his own country. But a scene of devastation meets his eye. His residence is destroyed, and his mother is not to be found till after a long search, when he discovers her in a little hut situated in the midst of a forest. She informs him that the desolation he has witnessed is the work of the people of Pohjola, who invaded the country in his absence, and anxiously asks him how he passed his time. He gives a glowing description of the place, and is particularly urgent in making his mother believe that he has had no intercourse with the women.

Going to the spot where he has left his boat, Ahti finds that sensitive vessel bitterly weeping at the inactive existence it is about to endure, and resolves on another expedition against Pohjola, in spite of the renewed remonstrances of his mother. This time, however, he takes with him an old companion in arms, named Tiera, or Kuura, notwithstanding the objections of Tiera's family, who state that he is newly married. On their way to Pohjola their progress is arrested by the spells of Louhi, at whose command the genius of Frost converts the sea into a sheet of ice. Ahti himself is nearly frost-bitten; but he terrifies the genius with his menaces, and at last returns home with Tiera, on horses which, in the plenitude of his grief, he has magically created.

The course of the narrative is now completely interrupted, and a new hero, named Kullerwo, is introduced into the story. Two brothers, Kalerwoinen and Untamoinen, harass each other by sundry petty annoyances, till at last Untamoinen, raising an army, destroys all the people of Kalerwoinen, with the sole exception of his wife, whom he takes home as a captive, and who gives birth to a child in the house of the conqueror. This child, who is called Kullerwo, is extremely precocious, and promises to become the avenger of his father. Attempts are made to exterminate him by drowning, burning, and hanging, but all prove fruitless; and when he is employed in various branches of labour his exertions are only mischievous to his employer, who, hopeless of turning him to any useful account, sells him to the smith Ilmarinen for a few old iron implements, supposed to represent his full value. By his new master, Kullerwo is employed as a herdsman; and the song in which he prays the gods to protect the flocks intrusted to his care may almost be regarded as an independent idyll. However, he soon becomes dissatisfied with the manner in which he is treated, especially when he finds in the middle of a very indifferent loaf a stone so hard that it breaks his knife, a relic of his father. To avenge this wrong, Kullerwo abandons his cattle to the bears and wolves, and making for himself a pipe out of a cow's horn, leads the wild animals to his master's residence. Ilmarinen's wife, who thinks the cattle have returned home, and goes out to milk them, is torn to pieces by a wolf